

Warrior Trading *Assistant*

A personal desktop assistant for applying Ross Cameron's Warrior day-trading strategy in real time. In v1 its one job is to *find the long entries and put them on screen* — you execute manually in DAS Trader Pro and manage the trade yourself.

▲ Long-only

Small-cap momentum · \$2-\$20

Entry recommendations only

It proposes — you execute (in DAS)

How to read this guide. It describes **what is actually built today**, not the eventual vision. **v1 is entry-recommendations-only**: the program does not track your positions or P&L, does not manage exits, and does not read Level 2 — those subsystems exist in the codebase but are shelved (see §1.2 and §6.2). The authoritative engineering reference is `CLAUDE.md` ; this is the human-facing companion to it. The colors below carry meaning throughout:

■ permitted / go / built ■ blocked / hard stop / risk ■ a caution or value that matters

■ a tool or context

Orientation

What the program is for, the hard constraints baked into it, and — most importantly — an honest map of what is built today versus what is deliberately deferred.

1.1 – THE THESIS

What This Program Is

A personal desktop assistant for applying **Ross Cameron's Warrior day-trading strategy** while you trade. It watches the market in real time, finds the kind of volatile small-cap momentum stocks Ross trades, checks each potential trade against his entry rules, and surfaces **long-entry recommendations** on screen — each with a setup name, an entry, a stop, and a target.

Two principles shape everything it does:

1 • Reduce risk first

Every design choice favors protecting capital over chasing upside, while still generally following Ross's strategy.

2 • Be easy to use

One native window, plain-language recommendations, and a single most-important number always in view.

Hard constraints baked into the program

CONSTRAINT · LONG-ONLY

It only ever recommends **buying**. Bear patterns — double tops, head-and-shoulders, breakdowns — are encoded **only as anti-signals**, never as entries.

CONSTRAINT · IT PROPOSES, YOU EXECUTE

The program **never places orders and never touches your account**. It recommends an entry; **you** decide, and **you** place the trade in **DAS Trader Pro** (manually) at your own discretion. A deliberate safety design — **you are always the one pulling the trigger**.

CONSTRAINT · YOU OWN THE EXIT AND THE TAPE

In v1 the program stops at the entry recommendation. Confirming the entry on **Level 2 / Time & Sales** and **managing the exit** (scale out at first profit, move the stop to break-even, bail on a catastrophic stop) are **your job**, off Ross's rules and your own screen — the program does not do them for you.

CONSTRAINT · SMALL-CAP MOMENTUM, SHORT HOLDS

\$2–\$20 stocks, up big on the day, low float, high relative volume — held **seconds to a few minutes**.

1.2 — READ THIS FIRST

What's Built vs. What Isn't

The single most important thing to understand: **v1 is entry-recommendations-only**. The program finds and surfaces the long entries; it does **not** track your positions or P&L, manage your exits, or read Level 2. And the recommendations come from a **deterministic rules engine** today — not from Claude reasoning live over the data. Here is the honest map.

✓ BUILT — THE LIVE v1 ENTRY PIPELINE

- Per-user **config layer** (your risk anchors + vendor keys)
- **Scanner** — Five-Pillars candidate scan on **Massive** data, true **free float** via **FMP**, **country** via SEC EDGAR
- **~18 entry-setup detectors** (micro pullback, bull flag, ABCD, VWAP reclaim, PM high/pivot breaks, dip trade...)
- **Hard entry gates** (four universe pillars + a **room-to-run** check) + **cautionary flags**
- **Market-regime** classification (informational)
- The **desktop UI**, trimmed to the entry-only view (market-conditions, recs feed, scanner board, ticker tape)
- An offline **backtest harness**

X NOT IN v1 — SHELVED / DEFERRED

- **No position / P&L / account awareness** — execution is manual in **DAS Trader Pro**, which has no usable API. No Record-Fills card, no P&L bar, no positions table.
- **No exit engine** — scale-out, break-even / catastrophic stop, MACD-flip / MA-break, bear-pattern exits are **doctrine you apply yourself** (the code is in-tree, just not wired).
- **No on-screen position sizing** — recs show entry / stop / target, no share count.
- **No Level 2 in the program** — depth is **your own eyes** (DAS), not a feed the app consumes.
- **No IBKR** — the account was closed; no TWS, no live broker connection.
- The **Claude "brain"** — recs are from the rules engine, not live Claude reasoning. Parked.
- **Sub-second print-trigger** — not wired; the engine runs in **bar-close mode** (1-min closes).
- **News pillar** — disabled (no vendor). The four price/volume/float pillars carry the scan.



WHY THIS SCOPE?

The data/execution stack changed materially on 2026-06-02 — IBKR closed, execution moved to manual DAS, and the float vendor moved from Ortex to FMP. Rather than ship half-working position/exit subsystems against a broker the app can't read, v1 was narrowed to the thing it can do well and safely: **surface the entries**. The shelved subsystems are kept in the codebase for a future version.

Getting Started

One-time setup and how to launch. Market data comes from Massive; true float from FMP is optional; execution is manual in DAS Trader Pro.

2.1 – ONE-TIME SETUP

Prerequisites & Setup

You need a Windows 11 machine, Python 3.12, and the `uv` package manager. Market data comes from Massive; **DAS Trader Pro** is your execution platform; an FMP key for true float is optional.

Required

Windows 11, **Python 3.12**, **uv**, a **Massive** (formerly Polygon) Stocks Advanced data subscription, and **DAS Trader Pro** for execution (with your own Level 2 / Time & Sales subscription).

Optional

An **FMP** (Financial Modeling Prep) API key for true free float (Pillar 5). Without it, the scanner falls back to the shares-outstanding upper bound and marks ambiguous names *needs-confirmation* instead of a hard pass.

Install dependencies

```
# from the project root
uv sync                                # install dependencies into .venv
```

Create your config

1

Copy `config/schema.example.yaml` → `config/user.yaml` . **That file is gitignored** — your API keys never get committed.

2

Fill in your **anchors** — the risk values Ross's ratio-based rules use (full position size, daily goal, max daily loss, your "barely-feel-it" per-trade loss, experience tier). See the table below. *In v1 these are mostly forward-looking — the subsystems that consume them (sizing, P&L caps) are shelved — but the schema still requires them, so fill them in honestly.*

3

Fill in vendor keys: `massive.api_key` (**required** for the scanner) and optionally `fmp.api_key` (true float for Pillar 5).

4

Any `ibkr` block is **ignored** (the account is closed) — you can delete it.

The anchor values

ANCHOR	WHAT IT IS
<code>full_position_size_shares</code>	Your full position size (e.g. 1000).
<code>daily_profit_goal_dollars</code>	Your daily goal (e.g. 2000).
<code>max_daily_loss_dollars</code>	Your hard daily stop (e.g. 3000).
<code>personal_barely_feel_loss_dollars</code>	The per-trade loss you'd "barely feel" — drives risk-based sizing.
<code>user_experience_tier</code>	Your experience tier (modulates sizing quality).



THE SCHEMA IS THE SOURCE OF TRUTH

`config/schema.example.yaml` is authoritative for **exact field names and which are required vs. optional**. If a field name in this guide differs from the schema, trust the schema.



HOT RELOAD

Edits to `config/user.yaml` while the app is running are picked up **without a restart**. A failed reload keeps the previous config and logs a warning.

2.2 - BOOT

Launching the Program

```
uv run python -m app.main
```

A native desktop window opens.



ALWAYS LAUNCH VIA UV RUN

A bare `python` lacks the timezone data the app needs and will report spurious errors (`ZoneInfoNotFound`).

A health check you can run without the GUI

```
uv run python -u scripts/runtime_smoke_test.py # boot the scan engine headless
```



EXECUTION LIVES IN DAS, NOT IN THE APP

There is no provider to pick and no broker connection to configure. The app surfaces entries; you place and manage every trade **manually in DAS Trader Pro**. (Earlier versions had Manual / IBKR P&L providers — both are shelved in v1.)

The Interface

One window, four stacked panels — the cosmetic crawl at the very top, a glanceable read on the market, the recommendations feed, and the scanner board.

3.1 — TOP TO BOTTOM

The Screen, Panel by Panel

When the window is open you'll see four panels, stacked top to bottom. The Live Recommendations feed is the heart of v1.

1 **Ticker tape** (very top) — a decorative news-style crawl of **every NASDAQ-listed common stock, alphabetical**, with live price and % change. Purely cosmetic; it does not drive any decision.

2 **Market Conditions** — a glanceable read on the *market*, not your account (detailed below).

3 **Live Recommendations** — a card appears whenever a setup fires and clears the gates (detailed below).

4 **Scanner board** — the autonomous candidate scan. Columns: ticker, country (China/Hong Kong flagged elevated-risk), last price, % change, RVOL, float, verdict. It **refreshes itself** on a timer — there is no refresh button.

i **NO POSITIONS TABLE, EXITS PANEL, OR RECORD-FILLS FORM**

Those belonged to the shelved position/exit subsystems. The P&L meters and loss-cap padlock that used to live in the dashboard were retired with them — the app has no P&L source in v1.

Inside Market Conditions

Regime chip

The market-regime classification (deeply-cold → cold → lukewarm → warm → hot), derived from market breadth. It sets the overall caution tone.

Market-shape flags

Round-trip-prone (leaders giving back gains — favor caution), *dispersed attention* (too many movers at once), *rehab* (reserved; not live).

Stand-aside banner

Appears in a *deeply-cold* regime to suggest favoring standing aside (A-setups only, smallest size).

Recommendation states

Each card shows the **setup name**, **entry / stop / target**, the pullback number (if any), a **blue-sky** tag when the stock is breaking a multi-year high, and any **cautions** (e.g. "below VWAP", "MACD bearish on 1m"). Its status is one of:

STATUS	MEANING
PERMITTED	Every gate passed; this is a tradeable long entry.
BLOCKED	A gate failed; the reason is named (shown in the <i>Suppressed today</i> sidebar).
WARMING_UP	A gate can't evaluate yet (indicator data still warming).

A co-firing group (two detectors on the same bar — e.g. micro pullback + half/whole-dollar) renders as a single stacked card with a "Confirmed by:" badge; CH 8-4 calls that combination "the very best version of the setup." (*SCALE_IN / SCALE_OUT card styles exist in the UI but don't fire in v1 — they need position awareness, which is out of scope.*)

Under the Hood

One deterministic pipeline: scan, detect, gate, recommend. In v1 it stops at the recommendation — from there it's you. Here's exactly how each stage decides.

4.1 — THE ENGINE

The Pipeline & Gate Stack

The engine runs one deterministic pipeline. A setup is recognized, the gate stack vets it, and only a recommendation that clears every **hard gate** is marked PERMITTED. In v1 the pipeline **stops at the recommendation** — confirming on Level 2, executing in DAS, and managing the exit are yours.

- ▶ scan the market → build the tradeable universe (Five Pillars)
- ▶ stream 1-min bars for each candidate
- ▶ detectors recognize a setup → gate stack vets it
- ▶ recommendation appears in the feed
- ▶ you confirm on L2 → execute in DAS → manage the exit yourself

Hard gates — these block a recommendation outright

HARD GATE · THE FOUR UNIVERSE PILLARS (ALL MUST BE TRUE)

Price \$2–\$20 · **% change** up $\geq 10\%$ on the day · **RVOL** $\geq 5\times$ (today's volume vs. its 50-day average) · **Float** $< 20\text{M}$ shares (true free float via FMP when available, else the shares-outstanding upper bound).

HARD GATE • ROOM-TO-RUN

There must be $\geq$ **~20¢ of room** from the entry to the nearest overhead resistance (the next whole dollar above, or the prior high-of-day when it sits above entry). A breakout straight into resistance is suppressed; a genuine **blue-sky** breakout (new all-time high, no overhead) is treated as unlimited room.

INERT IN V1 • OPEN-POSITION / DAILY-LOSS-CAP / HIJACK / REHAB

These gates still exist in the composite but are **inert in v1** — they need the position and P&L data the app doesn't have. Your **broker-side caps in DAS** are the real backstop (see §5.2).

Cautionary flags — these inform but never block

You see these on the card and decide for yourself:

MACD on the 1-minute

bearish / warming.

Below VWAP

price below, or VWAP warming.

News

no catalyst / unverified — *currently disabled as a pillar.*



WHY MACD / VWAP / NEWS ARE CAUTIONS, NOT GATES

Ross's biggest winners repeatedly trade against a cold 1-min MACD, below VWAP, with no news. Price action + supply/demand + Level 2 are primary; these three are advisory. A deliberate 2026-05-29 design decision — see [CLAUDE.md](#) .

CONTEXT

The **daily chart** is used as a *context filter* (overhead resistance, room to run, blue-sky) — **never as an entry trigger**.

4.2 — RECOGNITION

The Entry Setups (Detectors)

All detectors are **long / bullish** recognizers fed by 1-minute bars. When one fires on an armed candidate, it produces a recommendation card for the gate stack to vet.

Micro pullback

Bull flag

ABCD

Break of pivot

Cup & handle

Inverted head-and-shoulders

HOD breakout

Pre-market high break

Pre-market pivot break

Red-to-green

VWAP reclaim

Dip trade

Curling

First pullback

Double bottom

Half / whole-dollar breakout

MA pullback 5-minute



RTH-ANCHORED DETECTORS STAY QUIET PRE-MARKET

Red-to-green and **first-pullback** are anchored to the regular session and intentionally do not fire during pre-market.

4.3 — DOCTRINE REFERENCE

Exits — Your Job in v1

The program doesn't manage exits in v1, but the rules it's built around are the ones to apply **yourself**, off Ross's doctrine and your own screen. (The exit engine code is in-tree, just not wired into the running app.)

EXIT · FIRST-PROFIT SCALE-OUT + BREAK-EVEN STOP

The cleanest hardwired rule in the course: at the first profit target, **sell a portion**, then move the stop on the runner to **break-even**.

EXIT · CATASTROPHIC STOP

Honor your hard stop **immediately on the print** — these stocks move multiples of the stop width within a single bar, so don't wait for a candle to close.

EXIT · DISCRETIONARY SIGNALS

MACD flip, 9-EMA / VWAP break, 50%-retrace give-back, and the **bear-pattern confirmations** (double top, head-and-shoulders, top reversal, LOD break) as *exit* cues, consistent with long-only.

i IN A FUTURE VERSION THESE BECOME LIVE SIGNALS

The shelved exit engine emits all of the above as on-screen, urgency-ranked signals (with an alarm on a catastrophic stop). In v1 you run them by hand.

Trading With It

The full loop of a session — and the layered guardrails that stand between you and a bad day, in priority order.

5.1 — THE LOOP

A Session, Start to Finish

- 1** **Before the open:** in **DAS Trader Pro**, set your **daily max-loss and max position / order size** (see §5.2 — do this every day, it's your real backstop). Open your charts and your **Level 2 + Time & Sales**. Launch the app and glance at Market Conditions to confirm the regime and that your config loaded.
- 2** **Watch** the scanner board fill in and the recommendations feed.
- 3** **On a PERMITTED recommendation you like: confirm it on Level 2 / the tape** (the app won't do this for you), then place the trade **in DAS** at (or near) the suggested entry, with the suggested stop, at a size you've chosen.
- 4** **Manage the exit yourself** off Ross's rules: take the first-profit scale-out, move the runner's stop to break-even, and act **immediately** on a catastrophic stop. The program won't prompt these in v1.
- 5** **Mind the regime:** in a deeply-cold regime the stand-aside banner is your cue to be more selective (A-setups, smallest size).
- 6** **Stop when you decide.** The program runs whenever you run it; there's no forced time window.

5.2 — GUARDRAILS

Risk Controls & Guardrails

In priority order — platform-enforced limits first, because in a "hijacked" emotional state a trader overrides in-app warnings.

PRIORITY 1 · BROKER-SIDE CAPS — YOUR PRIMARY DEFENSE

Set a **daily max-loss** and a **max position / order size** directly in **DAS Trader Pro**. **Non-negotiable**. In v1 the app has no in-app loss padlock that actually fires — it can't see your P&L — which makes the DAS-side caps the *only* enforced guardrail. Set them every day.

PRIORITY 2 · THE UNIVERSE PILLARS + ROOM-TO-RUN GATE

Keep the program from ever surfacing a name that isn't a clean small-cap-momentum long with room above.

PRIORITY 3 · YOUR OWN EXIT DISCIPLINE

Scale-out + break-even stop and the catastrophic stop, applied by hand (§4.3).

PRIORITY 4 · REGIME AWARENESS

Be smaller / more selective in cold or round-trip-prone markets.



SHELVED / DEFERRED GUARDRAILS

The in-app *daily-loss-cap padlock*, the *trader-rehab* state machine, and a *hijack-state* gate exist in the codebase but are **not enforced in v1** (no live P&L source). Until they are, your DAS-side caps cover that ground.

Tools & Limits

The offline backtest harness, an honest accounting of what is not built, common fixes, and a map of the key files.

6.1 — LOOKING BACK

The Backtest Harness

An offline tool to approximate how the entry engine *would have* performed on past pre-market sessions. It replays historical 1-minute bars through the **same** detectors and gates the live app uses, and — to produce a P&L estimate only — simulates a simple exit model that the live v1 app does *not* run.

```
# last 5 trading sessions, 7-9am ET, default 0.20% slippage
uv run python -u scripts/backtest_premarket.py --days 5 --out report.md

# a specific past week (walks back from --asof, which is excluded)
uv run python -u scripts/backtest_premarket.py --days 5 --asof 2026-05-22 --out price.md

# tune the realism / window
uv run python -u scripts/backtest_premarket.py --slippage-bps 35 --window 04:00-09:30
```

Three fill models — so you see a range, not one misleading number

Optimistic

Perfect fills — the upper bound.

Realistic

Tunable slippage on market-style fills — the central estimate (`--slippage-bps` , default 20 = 0.20%).

Conservative

Pessimistic fills — the lower bound.

It also reports **peak capital deployed per day** (the most buying power tied up at once).



IT IS AN APPROXIMATION — READ IT THAT WAY

It cannot model Level 2; true sub-second fills are coarsened to 1-minute bars (so fill prices carry real error — that's why there are three models); and the daily universe is reconstructed from each day's movers (so it can miss pre-market-only runners that faded). Read it as **"roughly green or red, which setups fired, how often stops vs. targets hit"** — not "you would have made exactly \$X" — and remember its exit model is a backtest convenience, not how you'll manage trades live.

6.2 — HONEST ACCOUNTING

Limitations & What Is *Not* Built Yet

Entry-only

No position / P&L / account tracking, no exit management, and no on-screen sizing — you execute and manage manually in DAS.

Level 2 is your eyes, not the program's

The app consumes no depth feed.

No IBKR / no live broker connection

The account was closed; execution is manual.

No real-time Claude brain

Deterministic rules produce the recommendations today.

Bar-close, not sub-second

Entries evaluate on 1-minute closes; the print-trigger feed isn't wired.

News pillar disabled

Four pillars carry the scan.

In-app loss-cap / rehab / hijack gates not enforced

Rely on broker-side caps.

6.3 — WHEN SOMETHING'S OFF

Troubleshooting & Operations

SYMPTOM	FIX
Spurious <code>ZoneInfoNotFound</code> errors	Always use <code>uv run</code> — bare <code>python</code> lacks <code>tzdata</code> .
Scanner empty / "waiting for first scan"	Check <code>massive.api_key</code> is set and not the placeholder. Off-hours the board shows the prior session's gainers.
Float shows as shares-outstanding, not true float	<code>fmp.api_key</code> is missing or the name's float isn't in FMP's filings yet — the scanner falls back to the SO upper bound and marks the float pillar <i>needs-confirmation</i> .
A recommendation you expected was suppressed	Check the <i>Suppressed today</i> sidebar for the named gate reason; a common one in v1 is the room-to-run gate (entry too close to overhead resistance).
Config change not taking effect	A malformed <code>user.yaml</code> is rejected and the previous config kept — check the console for a WARN line.
Verify the install	<code>uv run pytest</code> runs the full test suite.

6.4 — THE MAP

Reference — Key Files

PATH	WHAT IT IS
CLAUDE.md	The authoritative engineering reference & invariants.
config/schema.example.yaml	Config field reference (copy to <code>user.yaml</code>).
app/main.py	Launch entry point & runtime wiring.
app/runtime.py	The live scan → detect → gate → recommend engine.
app/gates/	Hard gates (<code>composite.py</code> , incl. <code>room_to_run_gate.py</code>) and cautions (<code>cautions.py</code>).
app/detectors/	The entry-setup recognizers.
app/scanner/	The scan + vendors (<code>client.py</code> Massive, <code>fmp_client.py</code> float, <code>sec_client.py</code> country).
app/web/	The UI (<code>index.html</code> , <code>main.js</code> , <code>styles.css</code>).
app/backtest/ + scripts/backtest_premarket.py	The backtest harness.
app/exits/ · app/sizing/ · app/providers/	The shelved exit / sizing / P&L subsystems (in-tree, not wired into v1).
playbook/	The machine-readable distillation of Ross's course (the strategy source-of-truth).
Claude Code Session Handoff Documents/	Cross-session status; read the most recent first.

"Reduce risk first — then generally follow the strategy."

This guide describes the Warrior Trading Assistant as built in Phase 3 (runtime app), v1 entry-recommendations-only scope. It is an explanation of how a personal tool works — not financial advice, not a recommendation, and not a guarantee of any result. The program proposes the entry; you execute and manage every trade yourself in DAS Trader Pro. Trading small-cap stocks carries substantial risk of loss.

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